Steven Balalis

Technical Program Manager | Data Integrations, AI Delivery & Platform Operations

Lansdale, PA | Steven.Balalis@gmail.com | 609-947-5606 | linkedin.com/in/stevenbalalis

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Program Manager with 7+ years leading data, platform, and AI programs, and leading teams since 2016, across healthcare technology, health benefits operations, B2B SaaS, and public-sector environments. Owned 20+ data integration programs across 30+ partner organizations at Transcarent, and cut onboarding drop-off 22% while scaling platform capacity 50% at Persevere Now. PSPO I, Lean Six Sigma Black Belt, and AWS Cloud Practitioner with hands-on LLM engineering in RAG pipelines, AI agents, and QLoRA fine-tuning.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- AI Implementation & Service Delivery, Team Leadership & Mentoring, Customer Success Management, Product Roadmap Ownership, Backlog Prioritization & Requirements Definition, A/B Testing & Experimentation, OKR & Success Metrics Tracking, Agile/Scrum (PSPO I), Cross-Functional Delivery, Stakeholder Alignment, Platform Scalability & Reliability, Statistical Thinking (Lean Six Sigma Black Belt), Executive Communication
- **AI & Cloud:** AWS (Cloud Practitioner), RAG Pipelines, AI Agents, QLoRA / Fine-Tuning, LLM APIs (OpenAI, Anthropic), AWS AI/ML Services | AWS Certified AI Practitioner (AIF-C01 - In Progress)
- **Tools:** Jira (Admin/Power User), Confluence, ServiceNow, monday.com, SharePoint, Python, SQL, JavaScript / HTML / CSS, Node.js, MongoDB, React / Redux, Angular, Docker, Snowflake, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, Grafana, n8n, Lucidchart, Retool, Salesforce, Zendesk

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BCM One | AI Implementation Manager

July 2026 - Present | Remote

- Lead technical discovery and deployment support for Orbit AI, BCM One's AI voice receptionist built on the SkySwitch/NetSapiens platform, across a partner program covering about 71 channel partners, working alongside Account Managers to move partners from first conversation to live use; 30 partners are now live and selling it, with the program projected to generate six-figure revenue by 2027.
- Test and validate the Orbit AI API for CRM and workflow integrations, and support channel partners connecting it through the SkySwitch/NetSapiens platform (ongoing).
- Wrote and shipped the email slice of Orbit AI's white-label capability, so partners who resell the platform and their customers send all outgoing email from their own domain instead of @bcmone, in Python, JavaScript/Node.js, and SQL, deployed through GitLab CI/CD pipelines and monitored in production with Grafana and AWS monitoring; all 30 live partners use it.
- Shipped a production after-hours emergency-detection and dispatch-routing IVR AI capability that triages calls to emergency operations or EMS where applicable, validating call handling end to end against a 10-call QA test suite (10/10 passed) before release.
- Building an n8n workflow integration that connects Orbit AI's underlying infrastructure and integrations to third-party apps such as HubSpot (ongoing).
- Scoped about 10 new AI use cases since July 2026 through a structured intake, assessing business case, technical complexity, feasibility, and risk to recommend build, pilot, or decline, and take approved builds through Legal, Security, Compliance, and Internal Audit review before production release.
- **Feed field insights back to Product:** built an Orbit AI roadmap board capturing 18 distinct feature requests from 54 partner mentions, and wrote executive summaries for Product leadership naming the top demand (CRM and workflow integrations) and the main adoption blockers.
- Run regression testing and release validation on Orbit AI with the development vendor (Miratech): retest resolved L1 issues, file reproducible defects in Jira, and send consolidated feedback to speed up fixes.
- Packaged deployment resources into a SharePoint resource hub and a no-login monday.com intake form, giving internal teams and channel partners one self-serve path to request AIT help instead of ad hoc email.
- Lead BCM One's AI Implementation Team (AIT) as Product Owner and Scrum Master, managing 4 direct reports and running the team on 2-week Scrum sprints with Jira backlog refinement and story-point estimation.

Transcarent | Technical Program Manager, Data Integrations

September 2025 - June 2026 | Plymouth Meeting, PA (Hybrid)

- Owned product requirements, intake specifications, and delivery roadmap for 20+ data integration programs across a highly matrixed organization, aligning Engineering, Analytics, Customer Success, and 30+ external partners around shared roadmap priorities and delivery milestones.
- Translated complex business and technical requirements into clear product specifications, acceptance criteria, and user stories for cross-functional engineering and data teams.
- Defined and tracked product success metrics and OKRs across integration programs, establishing SLO/SLA governance frameworks that drove measurable improvements in platform reliability, data quality, and customer satisfaction.
- Triaged 15-20 weekly production issues (pipeline failures, schema mismatches, and delivery gaps) using SQL to query and read production data, identifying root cause and prioritizing solutions in collaboration with Data Engineering.
- Built a unified product observability dashboard with purpose-built query filters, providing real-time visibility into platform health, blocked items, and delivery status across the full portfolio.
- Pushed and deployed code changes through GitLab CI/CD pipelines and monitored platform health in production with Grafana and AWS monitoring.
- Co-led Team Operating Model workstream (WS6), designing standardized workflows, documentation architecture, and intake processes to improve scalability and platform consistency across a cross-functional org.
- Managed vendor and third-party partner relationships, overseeing integration requirements, performance expectations, and escalation resolution across 30+ external entities.
- Took about 59 partner data feeds live end to end, from account-management request and partner file layout through the Data Engineering build to validated test data before sign-off.
- Owned the executive relationship for 12 high-priority partner accounts (including Sword Health, Hinge Health, Maven, and Spring Health), running biweekly business reviews with 80%+ on-time delivery and 100% ultimate issue resolution.
- Supported Redshift to Databricks platform migration (WS2, P0), contributing to requirements definition, phased delivery planning, and cross-team dependency tracking.

Correlation One | Lead AWS Coding Instructor

May 2025 - September 2025 | Contract

- Taught Python, GitHub version control, and the software development lifecycle (SDLC) as lead instructor on an AWS coding program.

Persevere Now | Program Manager, Data & Platform Operations

November 2022 - May 2025 | Remote

- Led A/B testing and structured experimentation program to optimize platform onboarding workflows, reducing user drop-off by 22% through iterative, data-driven UX improvements informed by user research and behavioral analytics.
- Owned end-to-end product roadmap for a B2B SaaS platform, directing cross-functional delivery between Product, Engineering, and external vendors to scale platform capacity by 50% and grow learner enrollment by 25%.
- Administered Jira product backlog and Agile/Kanban workflows as Scrum Product Owner, defining and prioritizing user stories, aligning sprint delivery with strategic roadmap goals, and improving sprint predictability.
- Defined and tracked key product success metrics and OKRs; reported directly to CEO on platform performance, enabling data-driven investment decisions that doubled reported graduate outcome rates.
- Managed discovery efforts through ongoing user research, customer feedback loops, and market analysis, integrating insights into product backlog prioritization and roadmap planning.
- Authored product playbooks and SOPs for platform onboarding, integration workflows, and configuration; established escalation protocols improving cross-functional response times and stakeholder alignment.

Trenton Public School District | Technology Program Manager / Classroom Teacher

September 2019 - November 2022 | Trenton, NJ

- Led a 4-person team as Technology Program Manager.
- Managed end-to-end rollout of a district-wide digital platform across 30+ schools and 1,000+ staff; defined user adoption goals, coordinated cross-functional teams, and reported to executive leadership.
- Built product dashboards tracking learner engagement outcomes, driving 15% improvement in platform usage metrics through data-informed product interventions.
- Led multi-phase migration from legacy systems to modern digital infrastructure, owning stakeholder alignment, change management, and user adoption strategy.

- Applied UX and accessibility principles to design scalable digital content ensuring platform utility across a diverse district-wide user base.
- Spearheaded migration from legacy student information systems to PowerSchool, consolidating grading, attendance, and administrative data into a unified platform and reducing district software costs by 10%.
- Developed Excel-based dashboards to visualize learner engagement and platform usage data, enabling data-driven interventions that directly informed adoption strategy across 30+ schools.

State of New Jersey - Dept. of the Treasury | Pension Benefit Specialist III

August 2012 - September 2019 | Trenton, NJ

- Led a 5-person team of Pension Benefit Specialists from 2016 to 2019, overseeing health benefit enrollment processing for the State Health Benefits Program (SHBP) and School Employees' Health Benefits Program (SEHBP) and triage support with Horizon Blue Cross Blue Shield of New Jersey, and ran performance evaluations, training, and workload distribution for the unit.
- Drove the team's throughput at peak volume, processing thousands of health benefit applications monthly through end-to-end validation and manual entry workflows.
- Managed high-volume data reconciliation, building repeatable analytics processes to surface systemic issues and drive policy improvements.
- Automated workflows using Excel/VBA to cut data resolution time by 50%, achieving constituent satisfaction scores above 90%.
- Contributed to AWS-based CRM migration, supporting platform transition that improved compliance and operational efficiency.
- Coordinated triage and stakeholder support across internal teams, Pension/Member Benefits (PMB), and external health benefit carriers, serving as a central point of contact for escalations and issue resolution.
- Reviewed health benefit contracts between government agencies and service locations to assess and implement changes to individual and location-level benefit offerings during annual contract cycles.

EDUCATION

- MS, Artificial Intelligence & Large Language Models - Eastern University (In Progress)
- MFA, Educational Technology - Thomas Edison State University, 2022
- B.S. - Rutgers University, 2012

CERTIFICATIONS

- Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I)
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt
- AWS Cloud Practitioner
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner (AIF-C01) - In Progress (Anticipated 2026)
- Salesforce AI Associate
- **LLM Engineering:** RAG Pipelines, AI Agents, QLoRA / Fine-Tuning, Frontier Model APIs - In Progress (Udemy)